

Installing a LAMP Server

LAMP server is a misnomer for it is not one single server. LAMP is actually an acronym for Linux Apache MySQL P-programming languages. You already know Linux and we have told you about the Apache web server and the MySQL database server. Coming to the last part, 'P-Programming Languages', one interesting thing about the P part of LAMP is that it can be replaced by more than one word. All these words are the name of the server side scripting languages. The most common replacement for P in LAMP is 'PHP' with 'PERL' and 'Python' as the other alternatives. Due to the immense popularity of PHP both individually as well as in comparison to Perl and Python, LAMP sometimes is simply called as Linux-Apache-MySQL-PHP.

If you remove the 'L' part (and we mean to say if you remove Linux from the picture), you would also find packages which run on Windows and Mac. They are very predictably named as WAMP and MAMP respectively. However, since we are talking about Ubuntu Linux, WAMP and MAMP do not come into the picture.

If you are in need to install LAMP, the most geeky way is to install them by hand; compile them. For someone who would love to save time, an apt-get is the second best bet. In case you want to keep it simple and silly, Synaptic is the way to go. Simply go to the Synaptic package manager and install Apache 2, MySQL and PHP5. And you must not forget to install the packages which connect them. For example if you have MySQL and PHP5 but do not have php-mysql package, things won't work. While all this is much simpler than anything else, there is still the simplest method to be uncovered.

The simplest method would be to use the command called 'tasksel'. But before you go and run it, let us tell you – its not available with Ubuntu as a default package. The reason you ask for? Well, let us repeat it again – Ubuntu was made for home users. However, as we all know, there is nothing too complicated with installing software when the Linux distro you are using spells U-B-U-N-T-U. So launch a terminal and whisper to it:

- `sudo apt-get install tasksel`

Once done, run the command

- `sudo tasksel`

on the gnome-terminal and you will have an option to install many packages which require installation of a set of packages and then need you